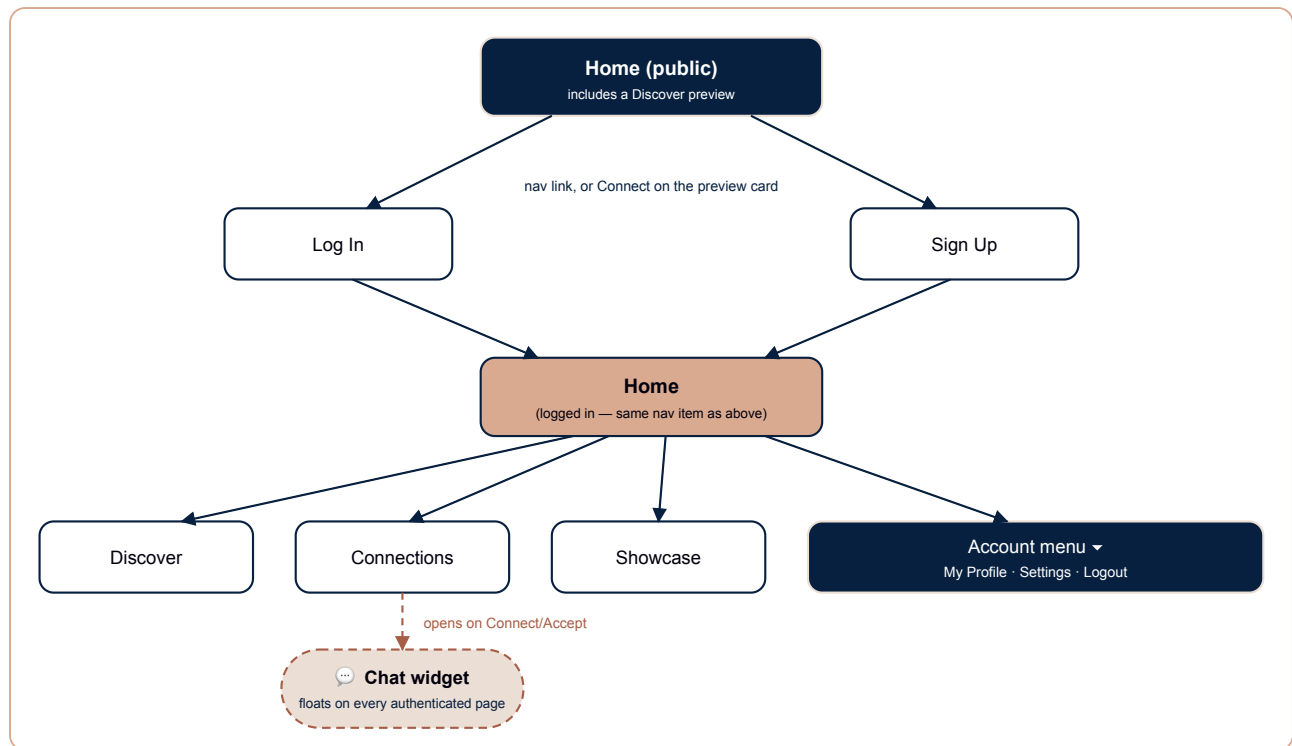


# Concept Documentation

SkillSwap — a skill-exchange web app

## Sitemap

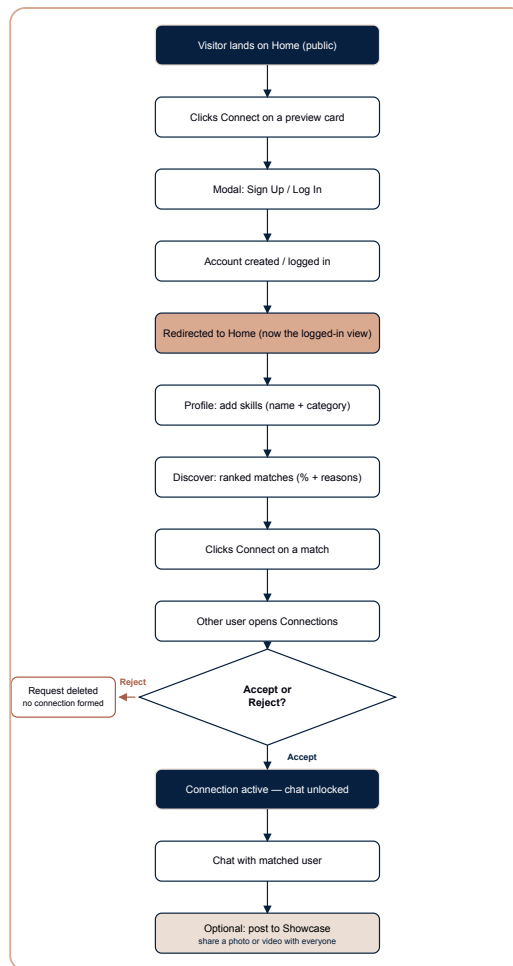


Home (public) — includes an embedded Discover preview

- Log In
- Sign Up
- Home (logged in — same nav item, now shows the dashboard view)
  - Discover — scored matches, search, category filters
  - Connections — chat threads, teach/learn tags, ratings
  - Showcase — photo/video posts with name + description
  - Account menu ▼ — dropdown, not its own page
    - My Profile
    - Settings
    - Logout

(Connect on a preview card, while logged out, opens the same Sign Up / Log In modal as the nav links)

# User Flow Diagram



Visitor lands on Home (public)

- clicks Connect on a preview card
- Sign Up / Log In modal → account created / logged in
- redirected to Home (now the logged-in view)
- Profile: add skills (name + category)
- Discover: ranked matches (% + reasons)
- clicks Connect on a match (request sent)
- other user opens Connections → Accept or Reject
  - Reject → request deleted, no connection formed
  - Accept → connection active, chat unlocked
    - chat with the matched user
    - optional: post to Showcase (share a photo or video)

## UI Concepts

---

Visual language, as built:

- **Color palette** — navy (#07203F) for structure and primary actions, tan (#D9AA90) for the "logged-in Home" state, cream (#EBDED4) for backgrounds, rust (#A65E46) as the accent for borders and detachable elements like the chat widget.
- **Layout** — card-based grids for people, used consistently across Discover, Showcase, and the public preview.
- **Match badges** — percent score + label + a plain-English reason, not just a bare number.
- **Category system** — 13 fixed categories via a custom dropdown, with an editable keyword-based suggestion.

## Design Iterations

---

What actually changed over the course of building this, and why:

- **Static single page** → **session-based multi-page app**. Started as a static concept, moved to real accounts and server-side sessions.
- **Added Python (Flask) + MySQL** as the actual backend and database.
- **Decided the data structure** — users, skills, connections, messages.
- **Built the matching/scoring logic** for ranked compatibility.
- **Added chat** — your suggestion, not in the original scaffold.
- **Added Showcase** — your suggestion, not in the original scaffold.
- **Added photo/video attachments** to chat messages.
- **Added a delete option in Showcase**, owner-only.
- **Top Matches: swipe-card deck** → **reverted to grid**. Simpler and more scannable.
- **Dashboard layout**. Reordered so Top Matches leads.
- **Categorization: keyword guessing** → **real category column**. Keywords now only power an editable suggestion.
- **Folded Settings/My Profile into one account menu**, out of the main nav.
- **Chat widget fixes**. Border, header alignment, poll-driven flicker, and re-scrolling once images/videos finish loading.
- **Fixed double video playback**. Opening a chat/Showcase video in the detached lightbox now pauses the inline copy, instead of both playing at once.